Jacob Hukill

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Research and Teaching Fields

Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Economics of Education

Education

University of Notre Dame — Notre Dame, IN
Ph.D. in Economics — May 2026 (exp)
Dissertation: *The Macroeconomics of Financing Higher Education*
Committee: Jeffrey Campbell (Chair), Zachary Stangebye, Jeffrey Denning
M.A. in Economics — 2024

Belmont University — Nashville, TN
B.Sc. in Economics and Political Science (Summa Cum Laude) — 2019

Working Papers

"Financing Human Capital Acquisition With Student Debt"

Abstract: I develop a life-cycle model of educational attainment, major choice, and student debt repayment to study how the structure and availability of student debt repayment plans impact human capital acquisition and the welfare of individuals. I first examine how the current system of income-driven repayment shapes both the decision to pursue college and the choice of major. I then evaluate the new Repayment Assistance Plan, comparing its effects on enrollment, major selection, repayment behavior, and welfare relative to the existing system.

"The Marginal Propensity to Consume Out of Student Debt Relief"

Abstract: I calculate the marginal propensity to consume student debt relief in a quantitative precautionary savings model. The fiscal expense of debt forgiveness is large and immediate, while the benefits free resources from recurring future debt payments, which reduces stimulus effects. By contrast, temporary forbearance that suspends current payments delivers immediate liquidity and produces MPCs close to those of cash transfers. Targeting a one-time transfer to indebted individuals rather than to all individuals raises the MPC by about 50 percent. The MPCs from debt relief are less than one third that of one time cash transfers, and less than one fifth that of cash transfers to indebted individuals, while forbearance nearly matches the effectiveness of transfers to indebted households.

Teaching Experience

- Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Notre Dame
  - PhD. Microeconomics I — Fall 2022 — Fall 2023
  - PhD. Microeconomics II — Fall 2022 — Fall 2023
- Instructor, Department of Economics, University of Notre Dame
  - Summer Math Camp — 2022 — 2023

Honors and Awards

- Graduating Senior Award, Belmont University 2019
- John W. Burgess Award, Belmont University 2018
- University Hale Leadership Award, Belmont University 2018

Technical Skills

Matlab, Julia, C++, CUDA, Python

Personal

Citizen of the United States.

References

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Last updated: October 29, 2025